

# Uttar Pradesh Footwear, Leather and No-leather Sector Development Policy 2025

Leather and footwear have been part of India's manufacturing story for a long time, but most of the attention has usually gone to the finished shoes on the shelf, not the industrial system behind them. The **Uttar Pradesh Footwear, Leather and No-leather Sector Development Policy 2025**, announced by the MSME & Export Promotion department, is meant to change that by pushing older clusters in Kanpur and Agra toward cleaner, better-built, and more export-ready production. The policy also supports the **Mega Leather Park Scheme**, which is one of the most important parts of that effort.

Agra is known around the world for the Taj Mahal, but in industry circles it has another identity too. It is one of India's biggest footwear centres. A large share of shoes, sandals, and leather goods made in and around the city move through local factories before reaching buyers in India and abroad. Kanpur has its own long leather history, with tanning, processing, and leather goods forming a deep industrial base. The problem has never been lack of skill. It has been older infrastructure, uneven drainage, pollution issues, and production spaces that need more support than they have usually received.

That is where the policy comes in. It focuses on modernising the old clusters instead of starting from scratch. One major part is infrastructure support,

which can mean better roads, workspace planning, utilities, and shared facilities that help factories function properly. Another part is effluent treatment support, which matters a lot in leather processing. Leather units use water and chemicals, so waste treatment is not a side issue. It sits right at the centre of

leather production organized instead of scattered and overloaded. That kind of setup can help smaller units become formal, improve quality, and work with bigger buyers.

This matters because leather and footwear remain major export sectors for India. Uttar Pradesh already plays a large role in both. A big share of the country's leather and footwear exports comes from the state, and much of that strength sits in the Kanpur-Agra belt. The products go to markets in Europe, the Middle East, and other places where buyers want scale, consistency, and timely delivery. But competition is tight. Vietnam, China, and Bangladesh are all strong players, each with its own advantages in cost, scale, or speed. If Uttar Pradesh wants to keep its place, it has to keep upgrading the way the industry works on the ground.

The policy is also about jobs people can actually see in their own cities. Formal work in leather and footwear can mean cutting, stitching, finishing, sorting, quality checking, machine operation, packing, and logistics. A park like the one planned in Kanpur can bring more of that work into organized units instead of leaving it scattered in smaller, less efficient setups. That is why the policy matters beyond the factory floor.

For Agra and Kanpur, the policy is a way of making an old strength work better in the years ahead. These cities already know leather and footwear well, so the job now is not to invent the industry again, but to improve the way it runs, grows, and competes.



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whether the cluster can grow in a cleaner and more sustainable way.

The **Mega Leather Park in Kanpur** is the clearest example of what this policy is trying to build. A leather park is not just a group of factories standing next to each other. It is a planned industrial space where units can work with shared infrastructure, testing support, waste treatment, and better connectivity. For readers who have never seen one, think of it as a single industrial zone built to keep

